Diploma in Lightroom

Precision Enhancements

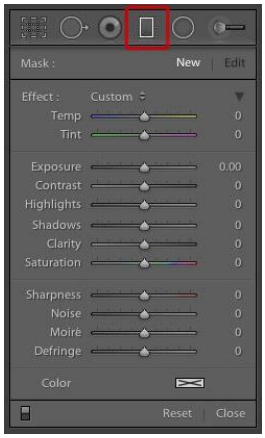
What are the localised adjustments?

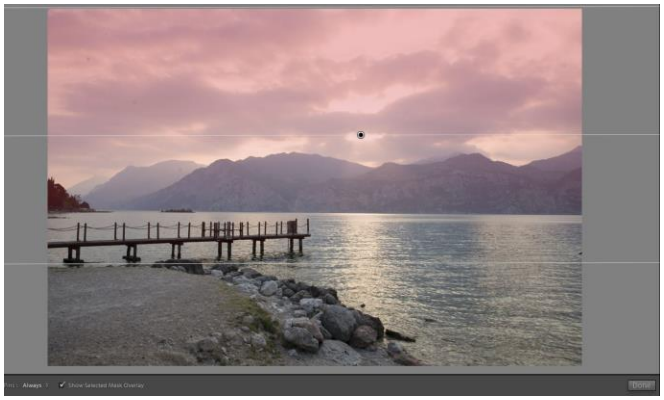
The controls in the adjustment panels in the **Develop module** let you affect the colour and tone of an entire photo. But sometimes you don't want to adjust globally, to the entire photo. You want to make corrections to a specific area of a photo. For example, you may want to lighten a face to make it stand out in a portrait or enhance the blue sky in a landscape. To make local corrections in Lightroom, you can apply colour and tonal adjustments using the **Graduated Filter**, **Radial Filter** and the **Brush Tool**.

- The **Adjustment Brush** tool lets you selectively apply Exposure, Clarity, Brightness, and other adjustments to photos by "painting" them onto the photo.
- The **Graduated Filter** tool lets you apply Exposure, Clarity, and other tonal adjustments gradually across a region of a photo. You can make the region as wide or as narrow as you like.
- The **Radial Filter** works similarly to the Graduated Filter and helps you to adjust a specific area of a photo.
- As with all other adjustments applied in the Develop module in Lightroom, local adjustments are non-destructive and are not permanently applied to the photo.

Graduated Filter

You can access your graduated filter through your Develop Module. Once you click on the filter, you will need to **click** on the photo, **hold** your finger and **drag** the cursor to define the area of interest.





1) (Optional) Make sure to have **'Show Selected Mask Overlay'** on, the see where you are positioning your filter. A red area will appear and it will tell you that the pixels in this area will be affected by your next adjustments.

What can I change with my filter?

- Temp
- Tint
- Exposure
- Highlights
- Shadows
- Whites
- Blacks
- Contrast
- Saturation

Clarity Other effects:

- Dehaze - Reduces or increases existing haze in a photo
- Sharpness - Enhances edge definition to bring out details in the photo. A negative value blurs details.
- Noise - Reduces luminance noise, which can become apparent when shadow areas are opened.
- Moiré - Removes moiré artefacts, or colour aliasing
- Defringe - Removes fringe colours along edges
- Colour - Applies a tint to the area affected by the local correction. Select the hue by clicking the Colour swatch. The Colour effect is preserved if you convert the photo to black and white.

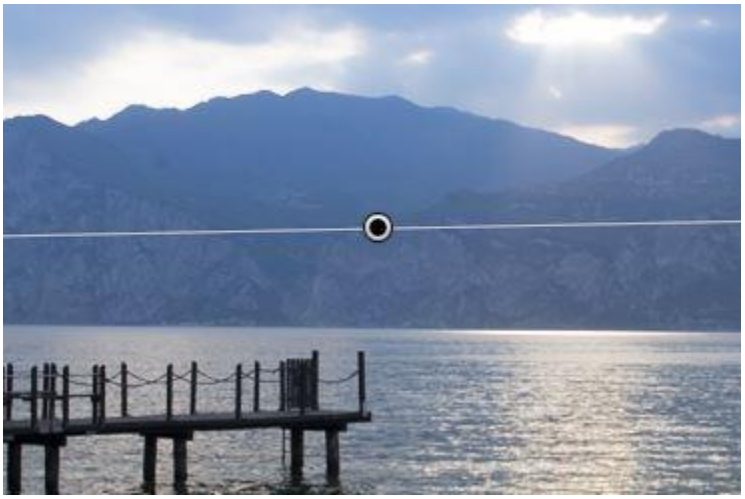
Remember, you can create more than one filter!

After you have created the first filter, a PIN will appear to show you that you have positioned your filter. If you click on it, you will be able to edit it your filter.

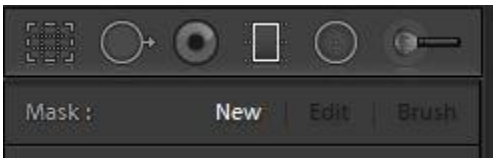
- You can re-position it, by just clicking and dragging
- You can rotate it. If you move your mouse on the middle line, you will be able to see two arrows.

You can now hold-click and spin it around

- To **delete** a filter, just click on the PIN and hit **Cancel** or **Backspace** on your keyboard.



To create a new filter, click on **NEW** and follow the same procedure described above. When you create and position a new filter, a second PIN will appear.

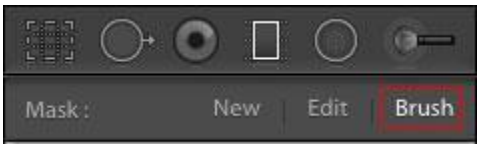


When applying and working with multiple local adjustments, keep in mind the following:

- **Click any pin to select it**. A selected pin has a black centre. Non-selected pins are solid white.
- Press H once to show the selected pin; press H again to hide all pins; press H a third time to show all pins.
- When the Adjustment Brush tool is selected, only adjustment pins are available to edit. When the Graduated Filter tool is selected, only graduated filter pins are available to edit.
- The Adjustment Brush tool drawer allows you to specify options for two brushes, A and B. Select a brush by clicking the letter, or switch between brushes by pressing the slash key (/). Brush options "stick" regardless of the effect you choose to apply until you change them.

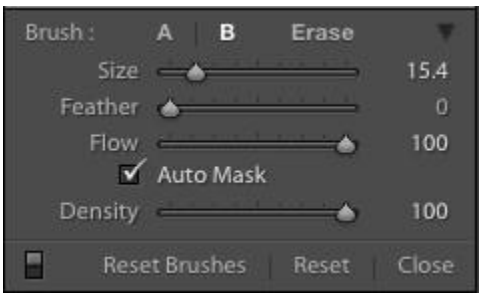
Modify a Graduated Filter or Radial Filter using brush controls

You can modify Graduated Filter masks using brush controls. Once you've added a mask, to access brush controls, select the Brush option next to New/Edit.



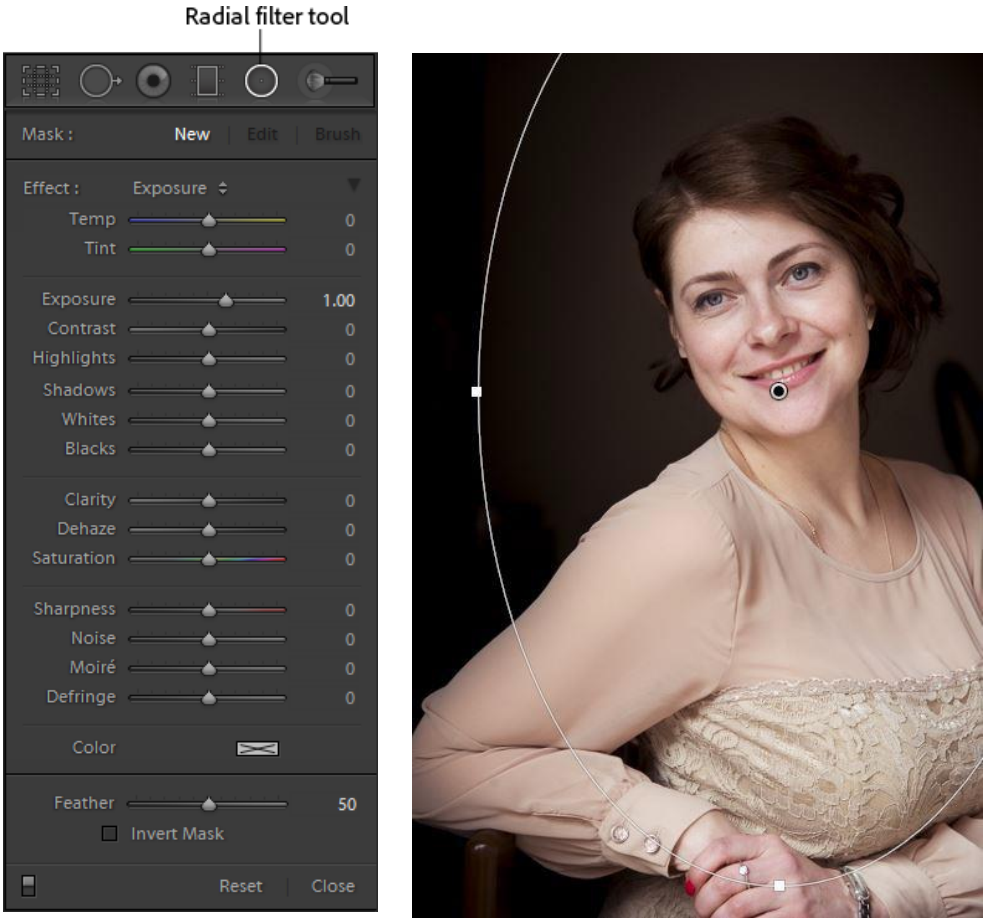
As appropriate, use the + and - (Erase) brushes. Lightroom lets you customize three different filter brushes: A (+), B (+), and Erase (-). You can customize the following settings for these brushes:

- **Size**: The size of the brush
- **Feather**: Hardness/Softness of the brush
- **Flow**: How much paint is applied to the area for every stroke (quantity). For example, if the Flow is set to 20%, 20% paint strength is applied for the first stroke. The subsequent stroke brings up the paint strength to 40%.
- **Density**: The maximum opacity that the brush paints. If you have this setting at 40%, for example, the brush will not paint opacity greater than 40%.



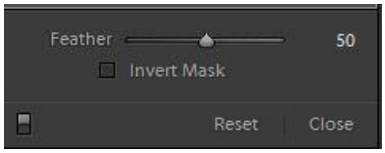
Radial Filters

As the Graduated Filters, you can access your **radial filter** through your Develop Module. Once you click on the filter, you will need to **click** on the photo, **hold** your finger and **drag** the cursor to define the area of interest



To determine what area of the photo is modified, select or clear the **Invert Mask checkbox**. The checkbox, by default, is not selected.

- **Invert Mask not selected** (default): Changing any setting affects the image region outside the marquee area.
- **Invert Mask selected**: Changing any setting affects the image region inside the marquee area.



Of course, you can modify it at any stage!

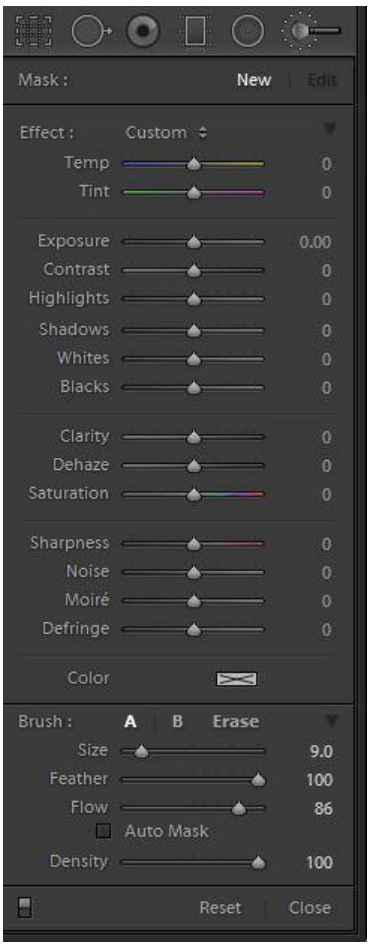
Adjust the size (width and height) and orientation of the Radial Filter added. Select a **PIN**, and:

- Click and drag the center of the filter to move and reposition it.
- Hover the pointer any of the four filter handles, and when the pointer icon changes, click and drag to change the size of the filter.
- Hover the pointer close to the edge of the filter, and when the pointer icon changes, click and drag the edge of the filter to change the orientation.

Adjustment Brush

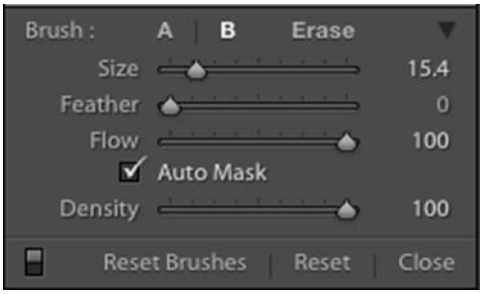
As the Radial Filters, you can access your **adjustment brush** through your Develop Module. Once you click on the brush, you will need to **paint** on the photo to define your area of interest

You can ALWAYS edit your brush!



Like the other filters, click on the PIN that has been created after your first stroke to edit it.

You can:

- **Extend the shape**, if you want to continue to paint
- **Refine the shape** created by clicking on the button 'ERASE'
- You can **delete your PIN** by clicking on the 'Backspace' or 'Delete' button on your keyboard
- **Create a new Brush** by clicking on the '**New'** button

Make sure to define your brush settings by using the following panel: